



Hydrogen flagship car

After its first hydrogen car, Toyota is reportedly working on building a higher, hydrogen fueled Lexus LS limousine <http://dgit.in/ToyotaLimo>



Tesla Roadster upgrade

Elon Musk announces that the Roadster upgrade will be able to travel 400 miles on a single charge <http://dgit.in/TeslaUpgrade>

Smart SoHo

So what's all this about ergonomics anyway?

Also regarded as human factors, ergonomics is a certain scientific discipline observed with the understanding of human interactions and thus applies the use of anthropometric data in order to design objects or processes while keeping human well-being and performance as its focal point. Basically, ergonomics is completely about designing stuff better for people, so that their interaction with products and processes enhances or complements them in a way that it improves their efficiency while not forcing them to adapt to these products or processes. In today's day and age, ergonomic design is of great importance as better designed products reduce unnecessary strain and help to keep our health in check while keeping us happy and productive.

Benefits of good ergonomics in a workplace

It's often said that "A happy employee is a productive employee" which is true in every sense as good ergonomics can go a long way in keeping people engaged and satisfied in their work. There is often the misconception that investing in ergonomically designed products or processes is extremely expensive and would do little to boost company profit or overall output of the company. Not only does ergonomic improvements in the workplace make it a happier and healthier environment, it also reduces unnecessary costs related to health and safety. Let's see some of the immediate benefits of good ergonomics:

- **Improved employee engagement:**

When a company is making visible efforts to improve health and safety of employees, it becomes easy for employees to notice these efforts and so they're motivated to engage more with their work. Ergonomic workplace design can be very influential in stimulating collaboration while also promoting learning. Efficient

collaboration of employees is the key to the success of any organisation and if ergonomics can help in balancing the "we" and "me" aspect of the workplace, it sure makes sense to invest in well-designed workplaces.

- **Reduced costs:**

According to reports from the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR),



An ergonomically designed chair from Herman Miller called Mirra 2

there has been a steady rise in the number of people making use of health services because of Musculoskeletal Disorders or MSDs and most of these people are working professionals who are victims of Repetitive Strain Injury. If a company reduces ergonomic risk factors in its offices or work environment, it can easily save its expenses on medical compensation for employees. A one time investment on ergonomic improvements in the workplace can thus save up a lot of money on recurring health related

expenses over a long term and is thus a beneficial investment.

- **Decreased health issues and a better safety culture:**

Good ergonomics in the workplace are directly responsible for decreasing repetitive strain related health issues which will help in keeping workers or employees healthy and lessen absenteeism from work. Also, a well designed workplace boosts employee morale and promotes healthier and safer work ethics.

- **Improved productivity and quality of output:**

Bad ergonomics increases fatigue, and fatigued people get frustrated and don't work at their best which can directly relate to a drop in the quality of their output. Improvement in productivity is one of the major advantages of ergonomics and this reason alone should ideally be enough for upgrading your workplace. Better ergonomic solutions will allow for better comfort, good posture, decrease unnecessary exertion and automatically make a person more efficient at work.

How can you transform a workplace to improve ergonomics

Transforming a workplace to better ergonomics starts primarily from creating and designing a job to fit the employee instead of forcing him/her to adapt to the ways of work. Apart from this, there are a few steps that you can follow to improve ergonomics to create a more productive workspace.

- **Identify risk factors:**

Take an account of your entire workplace and thoroughly identify the existence of ergonomic risk factors. Once you're done with that, broadly categorise and differentiate them into risks associated with force, instantaneous or quick motions, repetition, awkward postures, static postures, stress from prolonged contact and also variation in temperature.